

Are You Keeping the Sabbath

Hallelujah.

When the mind of Christ dropped on me and the gift of prophecy kicked in for the last three services, up until the last one, I was in the middle of teaching from glory to glory. I was even trying to finish breaking down 2 Corinthians 3. I opened up to it probably three times without ever going back.

Finally I just surrendered and rode that wave out until He finished saying what He wanted to say in our first encounter with the judgment line. I think He gave us about as much as we could understand.

Now I have been trying to go back.

It is interesting that when Paul gave us our foundation as an apostle born out of due season, he even steered some of the other apostles, in particular Peter, back into the foundation of the Church, which is justification by faith.

No matter who Paul was writing to, whether the Gentile born-again Church, the Jewish sector, a community in Rome, or Jerusalem itself, you can always see the foundation: how we came out of the law and how the devil keeps trying to get us back into some kind of legalism.

As Gentiles, we did not come out from under the law as a commandment from God to keep it. But the promise to Abraham was that in his seed all nations of the earth would be blessed. The law was added to that covenant with Abraham because of transgressions until the Seed, which is Christ, should come, to whom the promise was made.

Our heritage really has only one foundation to get straightened out. But when the Judaizers came, those who finally came to terms and agreed that the Gentile could be born again and God could become his Father, they still said that to perfect his faith he had to go on, be instructed in a more perfect way, and keep the law.

So in all of Paul's writings, to keep the foundation of justification by grace under the Church, he had to combat that continually.

We really have one heritage. The promise was to Abraham that we would be saved through his seed, which is Christ. The law was added to that. They kept trying to go back under the law, and this is where the whole argument against legalism came in, when Paul fought to keep the foundation under the Church.

That is why there is so much about the law in his writings.

When God opened all this up to Paul, especially in the book of Romans, what it did with strength was open the potential of everything we became in the new nature when we were born again.

When that opened up, we called it the Born-Again Trail and have been teaching on it for over two years now. I thought it was a six-month adventure. But since I found out it is the foundation of the Church, I do not believe there is an end to it. Now the whole Word of God is lining up. Where do you stop preaching it?

All I know is that now I understand it was not really even the Holy Spirit who set me free. He did the work, but the work was done in me, and what was left in me is what makes me free: the new nature. That is what set me free.

Some of you may remember that I said I could read the Old Testament through, but as far as doing exhaustive studies in it, until I thoroughly understood our dispensation of sonship, I just could not get a spirit of hunger to go in there and research all of those men.

But once He opened up completely the understanding I now have about being born again and how free I am, it freed me to go back and see the old in the light of the new, after I had been born again and had the Teacher on the inside illuminating me.

Then we went way back to Genesis. What a time we have been having.

I understand now. I am getting freer by the moment, and I cannot find any end to this.

Some of the greatest things Paul said about Moses, the veil over his face, and how all of that relates to you and me being born again, are amazing to me. Even under the shadows, I am beginning to understand things that were difficult all my life, like the Sabbath.

Why would the penalty be so stringent on the day of rest if a man simply bent over and picked up a stick of firewood? They brought him to the elders and had to put him in a jail of sorts until Moses inquired of God:

"He broke the Sabbath. What do we do with him now?"

God said, "Bring him before the elders of the church and stone him until he is dead."

A rebellious son reached manhood around thirteen. If he would not listen to his mother or father or take instruction, the mother and father would take him to the elders at the gate where they sat in council. She would say, "This son is a drunkard, and he is in rebellion. We have administered correction, and he never takes it."

Then the elders and the people would take that rebellious son and kill him there at the gate, stoning him to death.

Aren't you glad you are not under that dispensation when you have an outburst and run?

The penalty was really stringent for just picking up a piece of firewood on the day of rest. I am thinking the man must have lived in such fear on the Sabbath that he did not get any rest.

See what God had to contend with. He gave the law because of transgression until the time the Seed should come, which is Christ, through whom the promise was made, that through that Seed He would inherit the nations.

God had to deal with the rebellious sin nature, and He was very clear to those who wanted to go back under the law that the law was for the lawless.

Why would you need a commandment to do all those things if you had a new nature that freed you from them?

That is why you are judged now by the law of liberty and the advocate ministry of Jesus Christ. After you are born again and do something wrong, you go before Jesus Christ the Advocate, confessing a sin, and He is faithful and just to cleanse you.

That is what the priest did in the inner court, not the Holy of Holies, but the inner court on the brazen altar, where they brought sacrifices for the sins of the people.

That is what Solomon did first when he took over the kingship from his father David. The first thing King Solomon did was offer a thousand burnt offerings on Mount Moriah. God said, "What do you want?"

Solomon wanted to make sure that, underneath the advocate ministry of the Old Covenant, there was nothing between him and God when he took the throne.

God said, "What do you want?"

He said, "I want wisdom to judge Your people righteously, and I want to build You a house to dwell in."

That is the same thing we want. We want a spirit of wisdom to minister the Word and judgment righteously, and the house we are building is made out of the born-again spirits of just men made perfect.

That is the only house He wants.

God had to deal with that rebellious sin nature, which according to Paul, and I know he is right, could not keep the law.

Paul said:

"Is the law sin? God forbid.
Nay, I had not known sin,
but by the law:
for I had not known lust,
except the law had said,
Thou shalt not covet."

He said that was when he found out there was something in him. If you are born with the sin nature and grow up with it, how in the world are you going to know the difference? You do not know anything outside of what you were.

That is why Paul says:

"For what man knoweth the things of a man,
save the spirit of man which is in him?
even so the things of God knoweth no man,
but the Spirit of God."

He is not talking there about the Holy Spirit in the way people often assume. He is talking about your born-again regenerated nature.

The next verses say that you have not received the spirit that is of this world, the one Adam gave you. You received that spirit which is of God, born again, so you can know through the new nature the things freely given to you by God.

Before you had that new nature, it did not matter what you did. You could not give yourself a new nature. You could not save yourself. You could not beat a conscience or new nature into yourself. You cannot discipline one in. You cannot meditate one in. You have to be born again.

You can no more give yourself a new nature than a goldfish can adopt a piranha and beat one into him.

"Son, where were you last night?"

"I was having lunch. I had my friends for lunch."

The penalty was stringent, but when you start understanding the shadow, you see that it was the shadow of things to come. They said the body is of Christ. Meaning, the thing making the shadow is the Body of Christ.

Once the thing making the shadow gets here, it is impossible to live in the shadow and in the thing making it at the same time.

The Sabbath was a type of the rest you and I enter into when we are born again and cease from our own labors. It is not by your works, lest any man should boast. It is the gift of God.

A man working on the Sabbath was saying, in type, that your salvation could be earned. That is an impossibility.

If Joshua had given them rest when they crossed Jordan and entered the promised land, then God would not afterward have spoken of another day. There remains a rest for the people of God.

You enter that rest when you are born again, come out from under the weight and burden of sin, and receive a new nature.

Are you keeping the Sabbath?

Yes, I am, because I am guarding that peace. Glory be to God. I have been born again.

Is anybody hearing me? I have been born again. I have a new nature, and I know the secret of walking in the presence and power of God. It is not what men can give you. It is how you develop that human spirit, born again in the presence of God.

"I am going to fill myself with the Word."

Good, because the Word lays the foundation for faith. But faith takes place in your spirit. It comes from knowing Him who said what you are quoting.

Even when you walk the floor, say something five hundred times, and call yourself healed, when do you get healed? Certainly not by moving God. The one you are really affecting is your own spirit. You are speaking the Word until you conform to it in every area: spirit, soul, and body.

He who spared not His own Son, how shall He not with Him also freely give us all things? He wanted you to think about it. He did not spare Him, so how can you get Him to withhold any good thing from you?

"Why did He not give it to me?"

There is only one reason He cannot, if He cannot get you to receive it.

"I begged for it thirty-five days."

You are a professional unreceiver.

Hallelujah. Thank You, Jesus.

Can you follow me closely for a few minutes?

That new nature is everywhere I go. I want to get from glory to glory. He says, "You just keep spending time in My presence and developing your spirit, and you will find out what I can do."

Let us go to Luke 11:27:

"And it came to pass,
as he spake these things,
a certain woman of the company lifted up her voice,
and said unto him,
Blessed is the womb that bare thee,
and the paps which thou hast sucked."

Jesus said, in effect, "Yes, My mother is blessed. Yes. Yet, rather, blessed are they that hear the Word of God and keep it."

My hunger for food in my spirit dictated that I do not take a verse out of context, because a lot of what men taught me did not produce anything because it was wrong. You know the principles, because we taught you in meditation of His Word and assimilation: never take a verse out of context.

When Jesus said, "More blessed are they that hear the Word of God and keep it," the reason they would be more blessed is because they would end up being born again. They would receive the new nature.

Even then, a spirit was trying to get in and divert worship to Mary. Jesus said, "Yes, My mother is blessed, but more blessed are those who hear the Word of God and keep it," because they will go on to be born again.

That is what He talks about in the verses to come.

When the people were gathered thick together, Jesus began to say:

"This is an evil generation:
they seek a sign;
and there shall no sign be given it,
but the sign of Jonas the prophet.
For as Jonas was a sign unto the Ninevites,
so shall also the Son of man be to this generation."

Jonah was a sign to the Ninevites, so shall the Son of Man be to this generation.

The queen of the south shall rise up in judgment with the men of this generation and condemn them, for she came from the utmost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon. Jesus said, "Behold, a greater than Solomon is here."

The men of Nineveh shall rise up in judgment with this generation and condemn it. They repented at the preaching of Jonah, and Jesus said, "Behold, a greater than Jonah is here."

Jonah under the shadow was a type of Jesus. He was in the boat, the storm came up, and the boat was sinking. When they cast lots, the lot fell on him, so he said, "Throw me overboard."

They threw him overboard, just like you and I did. We threw Jesus overboard in our place when the human race fell to the storm of the sin nature. He descended to the inner parts of the earth for three days. As Jonah was in the belly of the whale three days and three nights, so must the Son of Man be in the center of the earth.

From hell He cried, which was typified by the belly of the whale. The whale spit Jonah up, and then he preached to the Ninevites.

Jesus was saying Jonah was a type of Him. They listened to Jonah under the shadow. Jesus says, "A greater is here," because I am not the shadow. You are going to get the real thing. You are going to be born again.

What is interesting now is that Jesus also typified Solomon. When I found out what Solomon's reign was a shadow of, I thought somebody nailed my shoes to the floor. I had no idea what He had said.

If you do not assimilate the whole teaching, you miss it. Take John, who ministered probably eighty years of his life. The book of Revelation was given to him, and he simply recorded it. John was a testimonial of Jesus, and he recorded that with the things he learned as the years went by.

He had about eighty years of ministering, and he was the one who knew Jesus. That is why he ended up talking more about the new nature and the love of God than any of them. But his crowning achievement was basically those five little chapters. That was his donation to the Church, and eighty years of wisdom went into five chapters.

That deserves a whole lot more respect than occasional skimming or quoting a verse to prove your point. We are talking about eighty years of a man's life.

I taught you how to meditate and assimilate. When you assimilate the way we taught you, you will be able to do what Psalm 1 says: meditate in the Word of God day and night. I meditate day and night on purpose because I have already created the bed for meditation that takes place by itself.

Hallelujah.

Do you think I try to know what I know? Do you think I painfully researched the connection between the Sabbath and the rest we enter into? No.

How did I know? By assimilation. When I got to the place where I could understand it, the Holy Ghost just popped it into me and said, "This is what it means."

"You think you are smart?"

No. That is my point. I do not.

Luke 11:32 says:

"The men of Nineve shall rise up in the judgment
with this generation,
and shall condemn it:
for they repented at the preaching of Jonas;
and, behold,
a greater than Jonas is here."

When I found out what shadow Solomon was operating under, I can tell you why Jesus would say, "A greater is here."

Luke 11:33 says:

"No man, when he hath lighted a candle,
putteth it in a secret place,
neither under a bushel,
but on a candlestick,
that they which come in
may see the light."

Then He says:

"The light of the body is the eye:
therefore when thine eye is single,
thy whole body also is full of light;
but when thine eye is evil,
thy body also is full of darkness.
Take heed therefore
that the light which is in thee be not darkness.
If thy whole body therefore be full of light,
having no part dark,
the whole shall be full of light,
as when the bright shining of a candle
doth give thee light."

Did He change the subject? No. This verse about the man lighting a candle is as much a part of verse 32 as verse 32 is of 31, 31 is of 30, and 30 is of 29.

What does it mean? It means a greater than Jonah is here, and a greater than Solomon is here. Why is He greater than they?

"Well, He is the Son of God."

Who does not know that? Why is He greater than they, as the next verses show? Because what they could not give us under the shadow, He can: being born again.

Can you give us a little hint?

Sure. A candle is to darkness what your new nature is to your spirit.

When this revelation started coming, I started writing as fast as I could. I cannot improve on it at this point, but I can give it to you.

Hebrews 2:14 says:

"Forasmuch then as the children are partakers of flesh and blood,
he also himself likewise took part of the same;
that through death he might destroy him
that had the power of death,
that is, the devil."

The only way to destroy Satan's hold over a person's life is to destroy the thing he is holding on to. That is the sin nature.

It is no harder for Satan to get people to sin who have the sin nature than it is to get a swarm of piranhas to eat a cow after you throw it into the Amazon. Before we were born again, the thing Satan used against us was the sin nature. That nature was part of our spirit.

No matter how many programs of rehabilitation you put that sin nature through, you are not going to change it, no more than a goldfish can adopt a piranha and beat a new nature into it.

It does not matter how many forms of religion we embrace or how many nights we spend in deep meditation trying to cleanse our inner self. The nature is not going to change, because that nature is as much a part of the spirit of a person who has not been born again as roadkill is to a vulture.

If Satan used our old sin nature to reign over us and develop us, hoping occasionally to find a likely prospect he can make a Hitler out of, thank God that now that we are born again, God wants to take our new nature, which is part of our born-again spirit, and reign through it.

This is what Paul meant in Romans 5:17:

"For if by one man's offence
death reigned by one;
much more they which receive
abundance of grace
and of the gift of righteousness
shall reign in life
by one, Jesus Christ."

That is the new life.

Watch out, devil.

Where does Satan find power to get a new generation to follow him into new waves of war, genocide, mass extermination, murder, rape, and drugs? By tapping into the fathomless depths of a human spirit void of God.

The part of a man Satan develops is the part of him that has the capacity to do all those things: his spirit.

The only part of a man God can develop to do the works of God is the part of you that has the capacity to do the works: your born-again spirit.

John G. Lake believed these things, operated in them, and knew that the divine flow of God's presence and healing power could only flow through a person's spirit who was fellowshiping with and touching God.

He wrote:

"Faith is a product of your spirit, not your intellect. Your intellect does not produce faith. Your knowledge may give you ground for faith, but faith is a product of your spirit."

He also said:

"Joy is something in your spirit. Happiness is something connected with your surroundings. You are happy because of your surroundings, but you are joyful because of your right relationship with your Father."

Faith, love, joy, and hope all spring from your spirit, being the hidden man of the heart. They are all products of your spiritual life.

The reason people do not have rich, beautiful faith is because their spirit is denied the privilege of communion and fellowship with the Father. You do not pore over the Word. You do not live in it. You do not spend time in fellowship and worship with your Father. Your spirit is depleted and weakened, and the faith that springs out of it is a weak and sickly plant.

John G. Lake ought to know. He was responsible for training 1,400 ministers, establishing 600 churches, and getting almost a million people saved in Africa in a period of eight years. No one could count the healings. I believe he knows what he is talking about.

Then, in five years in Spokane, Washington, close to 100,000 people were healed, causing Spokane to be the most disease-free city of that year.

The law was a type. It was a shadow of things to come. But once the thing comes that is making the shadow, which is the Body of Christ, it is impossible to live in the shadow and in the thing making the shadow at the same time.

In Colossians, Paul is speaking to those influenced by the Judaizers. Colossians 2:16-17 says:

"Let no man therefore judge you
in meat,
or in drink,
or in respect of an holyday,
or of the new moon,
or of the sabbath days:
which are a shadow of things to come;
but the body is of Christ."

Under the Old Covenant, King Solomon's reign came as close to perfection as could possibly be attained underneath the shadow of things to come. The wisdom, authority, abundance, glory, majesty, and power King Solomon commanded were a type of the new nature that you and I would receive when we were born again.

When Jesus talked about the encounter the Queen of the South had with King Solomon in Luke 11:31, He said:

"The queen of the south shall rise up
in the judgment
with the men of this generation,
and condemn them:
for she came from the utmost parts of the earth
to hear the wisdom of Solomon;
and, behold,
a greater than Solomon is here."

As great as Solomon's wisdom was, he still operated under the shadow of the rebirth and not in the new nature itself. When Jesus said a greater than Solomon is here, it is because He could take us out from under the shadow and into the new nature itself. With all of Solomon's wisdom, Solomon could not do that.

The new nature is to your born-again spirit what wisdom was to the reign of King Solomon.

Just two verses further down, it looks like Jesus changed the subject when He talked about why a man lights a candle and brings it into a dark room. But He did not. He was talking about what happens to your spirit when you are born again.

Luke 11:33 says:

"No man, when he hath lighted a candle,
putteth it in a secret place,
neither under a bushel,
but on a candlestick,
that they which come in
may see the light."

Jesus was saying that the whole purpose of lighting a candle is so a person can see where he could not see before and walk where he could not walk before because of the darkness.

He is talking about what happens to your spirit when you are delivered from the power of darkness and translated into the kingdom of His dear Son. Before the candle was lit and brought into the room, there was nothing but darkness. It was the same with your spirit before you were born again and received the new nature.

There was nothing but darkness. But now that your spirit has been born again and received a new nature, you can see where you could not see and walk where there was once darkness.

Jesus went on to say:

"The light of the body is the eye:
therefore when thine eye is single,
thy whole body also is full of light;
but when thine eye is evil,
thy body also is full of darkness.
Take heed therefore
that the light which is in thee be not darkness.
If thy whole body therefore be full of light,
having no part dark,
the whole shall be full of light,
as when the bright shining of a candle
doth give thee light."

When Jesus said the light of the body is the eye, He was saying your eyes are to your body what your new nature is to your spirit. They both supply the light we need to walk in.

Your natural man would be in total darkness if it were not for the eyes. Your spirit man would be in total darkness if it were not for the new nature. As clearly as your natural eyes let light into your body so you can walk by the light, your new nature is what God uses to illuminate your spirit, for it is only through your spirit that you can understand spiritual things.

Proverbs 20:27 says:

"The spirit of man is the candle of the Lord,
searching all the inward parts of the belly."

When Jesus said, "If thine eye be single, thy whole body shall be full of light," the Greek word for "single" is *haplous* and means a healthy eye, free of disease and able to see clearly. Jesus is using this natural parable to help you understand the spiritual application.

The perfect state of the natural man is to have healthy, disease-free eyes so he can see clearly. Your eyes are to your natural man what your new nature is to your spirit.

On the other hand, Jesus said, "If thine eye be evil, thy whole body shall be full of darkness." The Greek word for evil is *poneros* and means ill, worthless, or diseased. Blind eyes are to the natural man what the darkness of the sin nature is to the spirit of a man who has not been born again.

Jesus said if your whole body is full of light, having no part dark, the whole shall be full of light, as when the bright shining of a candle gives light. In the natural, if the whole body is full of light, having no part dark, it is because you have a healthy set of eyes and can see clearly through a whole range of vision, peripheral and forward.

Because your eyes are to your body what your new nature is to your spirit, the fact that Jesus said, "having no part dark," means there can be a part that is still dark even though you have been born again.

You see that all the time in the Body of Christ: people who do not believe in speaking in tongues, healing, or prophesying. People who have been born again and have a new nature can still be partially blinded to truth by darkness.

But none of that changes the potential we have through our new nature. Even though a person may be taught wrong, you must understand that he still has the capacity and unlimited potential to be taught right.

When Jesus told the men of His generation that the Queen of the South would rise up against them in judgment and condemn them because she came from the uttermost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon, He said:

"Behold, a greater than Solomon is here."

As I said before, He said that because as great as Solomon was, he still only operated in the shadow of the rebirth, not in the rebirth itself.

But not you and me. The greater One, Jesus, has come and has not given us the shadow. He has given us the new nature itself.

If you want to see the potential of the born-again spirit under the shadow, all you have to do is look at King Solomon's reign. Under his reign, the type of the rebirth came to its fullness. The wisdom of Solomon was a type. But because he operated in the shadow of the rebirth and not the rebirth itself, he still had a sin nature.

Later, even after all God did for him, the seven hundred wives, princesses, and three hundred concubines Solomon loved turned his heart away from God. He even began to build temples to their gods. God told him, "Had it not been for the promise I made to your father David, I would have ripped you off that throne."

But when King Solomon was at his fullness, he was something to behold.

Under the shadow, the anointing of the rebirth is where the book of Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, and Song of Solomon came from. Even Jesus made reference to his wisdom.

Under the shadow, the wisdom King Solomon reigned with was a type of what the new nature is to your spirit.

When the Queen of the South, who was not lacking in wisdom herself and ruled over a whole kingdom, heard the wisdom of Solomon, there was no more spirit left in her.

Let me tell you what that means. There was not even a microfiber of anything anywhere in her entire being that did not totally succumb to the wisdom of Solomon. It was so strong that it did not just leave her surrendered; it left her stunned.

Second Chronicles 9:3-4 says:

"And when the queen of Sheba had seen
the wisdom of Solomon,
and the house that he had built,
and the meat of his table,
and the sitting of his servants,
and the attendance of his ministers,
and their apparel;
his cupbearers also,
and their apparel;
and his ascent by which he went up
into the house of the Lord;
there was no more spirit in her."

In the same breath, you knew Nineveh and Jonah's preaching to it were a type of the salvation we would receive: repentance, His death, our baptism into His death, and His resurrection.

But when Jesus said, "A greater than Solomon is here," Solomon operated in the shadow of the rebirth. In his reign, that shadow came the closest to the perfection of the real thing.

The greater One has come, Jesus, who took us out of the shadow into the real thing. What wisdom was to Solomon's reign, my new nature is to my spirit.

What is ahead of us? You are not going to find out if, like Solomon, you marry a thousand strange doctrines. You will marry seven hundred strange doctrines and have affairs with three hundred more until you enter into fellowship with God and, through the Holy Spirit, have a relationship with your one wife.

Hallelujah.

Let your Father develop your spirit. Let Him take you out and beyond what the shadow operated in, into the glory, wisdom, and all God has for us as sons and daughters of God.

Obviously, the wives of Solomon cannot give that to you, and neither can their gods.

I have been born again. There is no limit to the potential I walk in.

Hallelujah.

This world does not have enough sin to escape the velocity of the reign of the born-again spirit. He is just looking for a few good men and women who have not been deceived into quitting before they get there.

Hallelujah.

If there were not more to it than having camp meetings, swapping meetings, and swapping offerings, then I would find a branch on the Amazon and at least get somebody saved. Before I would sit around in meetings and swap offerings, I would march up and down Peoria, laugh at their switchblades, and get them born again.

If you are ever going to have God show up, you probably have to place yourself somewhere between the need of the human race and God, to give Him a reason to show up, instead of sitting around like some dark hole in outer space, sucking everybody into your problems.

If you want to walk with God, you need to be the answer.

Under the shadow, the wisdom Solomon reigned with was a type of what my new nature is to my born-again spirit.

"I just cannot believe that."

That is because you have a defeated complex.

You want to talk victory? Victory is not your bank account. Victory is being able to operate in spite of it. Victory is defeating every trap of Satan, whether persecution or the lust for other things, and finishing your journey to become a slave and servant of God.

Hallelujah.

There is another part we explored about the death nature and its little haunts: how can you know your capacity for victory unless you knew what your capacity was for destruction?

If that death nature can make a Hitler out of any one of you with special training, then what can the abundance of grace and the gift of righteousness make out of a man who wants to reign through the life of the new nature by Christ Jesus?

The world would have a hard time outrunning you to go to hell then, would it not?

Stand up and lift those hands.

Hallelujah, Jesus. Jesus.

Thank You. Thank You for the shadow. Help this little brain of mine understand the real.

Glory be to God. Hallelujah. Hallelujah. Hallelujah.

My day in court. If I fail, do not let it be because somebody held the truth from me. Tell me the truth. Leave it up to me if I am going to be a miserable failure.

Do not take my right to victory away from me.